

School: Suffield Park Infants and Nursery

Date: 19 October 2022

Report: Onsite consultation and audit walk

DPE: Stuart Lee

Staff member: Nicola Steward

The consultation included an audit walk and an update on latest actions, including updating staff lists, policy documentation, information security and staff training. Details below:

Audit walk

It was evident that the school had been proactive with raising staff awareness regarding what data should and should not be on display; forename only for lists, books and displays; folder systems used; photocopiers with secure codes; confidential waste is shredded; work spaces were clear and tidy; lockable storage with staff spoken to being aware of their responsibilities for handling and storing personal information. The school has also been innovative in ways to display information for the day i.e. dry wipe information boards are used to display information for the current working day that can then be wiped at the end of the school day. The following was highlighted for follow up considerations:

Visitor signing in

The signing in book is a closed book system although each visitor can see each other's information.

Recommendations: The school to consider a carbon copy book or a cheaper method is to have one sheet per sign-in for visitors.

The schools can also add the following statement to the visitor sign in the area: Please refer to the general privacy notice available on the school website if you would like to know more about how the school protects your data.

Deputies/Site manager's office

As facilities folders are in the deputies office where sensitive data is processed, the school will move site facilities folders to the site manager's office. NS will also move care plans to a central location (i.e. admin office).

Risk/Care plans

There was 1 x photo for no consent (Shark class) and nut allergy on display and 1 x classroom with care plan/risk management plan (Seahorse)s on the back of the cupboard door. There was also a care plan folder in the staffroom.

Recommendation: School to review how care plans/risk plans are displayed and NS to consider folder systems and storing care plans centrally.

CCTV

The CCTV base unit is positioned in the front office with the display. CCTV is used for staff and student safety.

Recommendation: The school to consider whether the CCTV base unit can be moved and/or added to a secure cabinet. The office is locked at night and has restricted access so risks of access to the base unit being accessed have been partly mitigated

Other follow up actions:

NS to move GDPR documents to the main policy area (currently displayed in the parents section).

Website documents to consider displaying:

- GDPR/data protection policy
- Privacy notice(s)
- SAR and data breach procedure
- FOI and publication scheme
- Supplier/third party list

Other useful documents to review and check that you have are:

- Work away from school policy
- Information Security/Passwords
- Review of consent documentation. Consent guidance and consent withdrawal can also be added to the GDPR section of the school website

Information security

SL discussed the recent NCC themed cyber security audit with NS. The school had already gone through the audit with their IT provider. SL discussed with the school IT technician the position of the server (positioned in reprographics). Risks were discussed and it was ascertained that at present this is the best position for the server; restricted access and door locked at night.

There is also an information security best practice area with policy documentation, links to other related best practice areas (passwords) and lots of content regarding latest threats in the sector:
<https://dataprotection.education/best-practice-library/best-practice/information-classification>

In addition, you can check out the National Cyber Security Centre website: [ncsc.gov.uk](https://www.ncsc.gov.uk) which has useful resources and tips for schools regarding cyber security:

- **School resources:** <https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/section/education-skills/schools>
- **Governor Qs for schools:** <https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/information/school-governor-questions>

Password manager

SL discussed different password managers and for NS to check with the schools IT provider regarding if there was a recommended product she could use.

Staff training and raising staff awareness

Staff had already completed DPEs Introduction to Data Protection Training and NS has been and continues to raise awareness in school. SL recommend staff complete the following e-learning modules: [Stay Safe Online NCSC Training](#) (supports cyber security)

Data retention

We discussed data retention and information specifically related to SCR and DBS checks. SL recommended that there should also be a record of who has been at the school. If the school only uses the SCR and not for example, record in the MIS there is a risk that personnel who have worked at the school could be deleted (i.e. volunteers). The SCR is meant as a snapshot hence the latest guidance is for schools to delete records when someone leaves. However, schools can still retain selected data i.e. name and verification information. We discussed risks in keeping and for deleting such data. The school will decide on a system that works for them (i.e. archiving leavers) and record in their retention schedule. References to the latest guidance is detailed below:

1) how long should schools keep DBS documentation for?

1. DBS - [Keeping Children Safe in Education](#) - P72, section: 276/277

275.' Schools and colleges do not have to keep copies of DBS certificates in order to fulfil the duty of maintaining the single central record. To help schools and colleges comply with the requirements of the Data Protection Act 2018, when a school or college chooses to retain a copy, there should be a valid reason for doing so and it should not be kept for longer than six months. When the information is destroyed a school or college may keep a record of the fact that vetting was carried out, the result and the recruitment decision taken if they choose to.'

276.'Copies of DBS certificates and records of criminal information disclosed by the candidate are covered by UK GDPR/DPA 2018 Article 10. [89] A copy of the other documents used to verify the successful candidate's identity, right to work and required qualifications should be kept on their personnel file.'

2) When a staff member leaves - how long should their information be held on the Single Central Record?

[Keeping Children Safe in Education](#) - P71, section: 272.

272. 'The details of an individual should be removed from the single central record once they no longer work at the school or college.'

However, to allow the school to maintain a history of who has been at the school, the school should decide what relevant information can be securely retained and this could be in the form of a

minimised archived record as detailed above. The school should document this in the retention schedule.

Note: Organisations can set deadlines, document and justify timeframes they have set for retaining data. There are **two key factors**: the **purpose** for processing the data, and any **legal or regulatory requirements** for **retaining it**. One of your purposes will need to apply for you to continue to store the data. Data should not be held for longer than is needed. You shouldn't just keep data just in case you may need it in the future.